1

Getting Started and Lakehouse Concepts

"Give me six hours to chop down a tree, and I will spend the first four sharpening the axe."

– Abraham Lincoln

We will start with a basic overview of how **Databricks Data Intelligence Platform** (**DI**) is an open platform on a **lakehouse** architecture and the advantages of this in developing **machine learning** (**ML**) applications. For brevity, we will use terms such as *Data Intelligence Platform* and *Databricks* interchangeably throughout the book. This chapter will introduce the different projects and associated datasets we'll use throughout the book. Each project intentionally highlights a function or component of the DI Platform. Use the example projects as hands-on lessons for each platform element we cover. We progress through these projects in the last section of each chapter – namely, applying our learning.

Here is what you will learn in this chapter:

- Components of the Data Intelligence Platform
- Advantages of the Databricks Platform
- Applying our learning

Components of the Data Intelligence Platform

The Data Intelligence Platform allows your entire organization to leverage your data and AI. It's built on a lakehouse architecture to provide an open, unified foundation for all data and governance layers. It is powered by a **Data Intelligence Engine**, which understands the context of your data. For practical purposes, let's talk about the components of the Databricks Data Intelligence Platform: